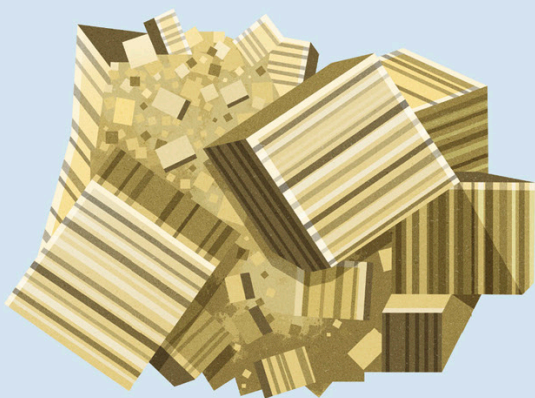


Pyrite



This mineral is often called “fool’s gold”, and you can see why! It has tricked many people hunting for treasure. Instead of getting rich, they were left disappointed, because this mineral is more common than gold and not worth much. Its real name is pyrite, and it has a shiny, metallic surface. In fact, it is made of iron metal as well as the yellow element sulphur.

Pyrite often has cube-shaped crystals. Their sides are so straight and perfect that they look as if they were made by machines. Sometimes the crystals have straight ridges running along them, which gives them the appearance of stripy boxes.

*In the past, shiny slices of pyrite
were made into mirrors.*

